

Preface

There are some very credible philosophical theories (not vetted by computer scientists) that claim that, in all likelihood, we're living in a simulated reality. Most of their proposals do not involve sentient artificial intelligences that use humankind as a source of energy though.

It's also sadly true of this Fast Track – and it behoves us to be upfront about such things – that after reading it you won't gain the ability to bend the world to your will unless you happen to have just that much raw charisma. Nor will your electricity bills be lightened by using your friends, relatives and pets as sources of energy.

What, you might then wonder, is this booklet good for? Good question. By reading this book, you'll gain the ability to run Windows 95 using your mind. Of course there are fingers, a computer and a few downloads involved, but it's still all the mind's doing.

Can't afford to buy a 10" tablet? We'll teach you how to emulate a tablet on your computer. They're really a lot more useful if you can click on them from a 23" desktop screen. That whole portability thing is a gimmick, trust us.

In all seriousness though, there's a lot to learn about emulation, and we aim to cover as much of it as possible. Here's what you should look forward to in this booklet.

After a brief introduction to the world of emulation, we'll try to clarify a few of the terms often mentioned in this topic including emulation, virtualisation and simulation.

Then, we'll go on to tackle methods by which various operating systems can run alongside on your computer without messing with partitions and boot loaders using emulators. You'll also learn to emulate mobile operating systems on your desktop.

We'll then look at emulation on the internet with services that let you emulate various platforms (as well as browsers) from the comfort of a browser.